

LEVEL 1 · WRITE-UP

Look Up

Each line is Base64. Decoding, for example, the first:

```
QXogKzE50MKwMTcnMzQuMyIgIEFs dCArNTbCsDMzJzAwLjIi
↓ (From Base64, UTF-8)
Az +198°17'34.3" Alt +56°33'00.2"
```

These are horizontal (Az/Alt) coordinates — where a star sits in the sky from one place at one instant. Open stellarium-web.org, set the location to Dhanbad and the time to 9 Oct 2026, 04:30 IST, then search each azimuth/altitude to identify the star.

The six stars:

Rigel — Az +198°17'34" Alt +56°33' — distance ~860 ly

Capella — Az +343°31'39" Alt +66°33' — distance ~43 ly

Alnilam — Az +190°51'03" Alt +64°37' — distance ~1,340 ly

Menkalinan — Az +2°38'46" Alt +68°51' — distance ~81 ly

Aldebaran — Az +252°11'14" Alt +70°12' — distance ~65 ly

Elnath — Az +308°53'24" Alt +82°04' — distance ~134 ly

The clue says “where it came from, but first reaches you.” Light from the nearest star reaches you first. Order the stars by distance, nearest → farthest, and take the first letter of each:

```
Capella (43) → C
Aldebaran (65) → A
Menkalinan (81) → M
Elnath (134) → E
Rigel (860) → R
Alnilam (1340) → A
= C A M E R A
```

CTC{camera}

Leads to: the next page of the notebook is headed “what the camera saw.”